



In Memoriam David A. Kendrick (1937–2024)

Co-founder of the Journal *Computational Economics*

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1 In Loving Memory of David Kendrick

Our lifetime friend David Kendrick, born on November 14, 1937, in Gatesville, Texas, embarked on a remarkable journey that touched the hearts and minds of many in our community. With profound sadness, we bid farewell to a beloved husband, father, friend, and esteemed scholar who left an unforgettable mark on our lives. David passed away on April 7th, 2024 at the age of 86 in his hometown Austin.

1.1 The Academic

At the beginning of his career, David considered going into politics as he had been working as an assistant to Texas congressman W. R. Poage. Fortunately, for our community, David was more intrigued by science and felt less suited for a political career. After obtaining his Bachelor's degree at the University of Texas (UT) at Austin, David left Texas to pursue a Ph.D. at MIT (1966) that laid the groundwork for his later research interests in *Sectoral Economics and Planning* and *Optimal Control/optimization problems*, common in engineering. After finishing his Ph.D. he started working as an assistant professor at Harvard. (1966–1970).

Homeward-bound, David returned to his roots at the University of Texas as the Ralph W. Yarborough Centennial Professor of Liberal Arts in the early Seventies, where he began his groundbreaking research in stochastic control in (macro) economics. His passion for economic dynamics and control problems led him to serve as the founding editor of the *Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control*. He took great care in establishing the standing of the JEDC in the economics and engineering community. Under his editorial leadership JEDC attracted the attention of economists as well as engineers keen to contribute to the advancement of economic dynamics and the computational methods required to achieve this. In 2002 the JEDC published a special issue honoring David's work with contributions of many well known economists.¹

In 1981, David's seminal work, *Stochastic Control for Economic Models*,² illuminated the path forward for economists, laying the foundation for the importance of stochastic control theory in economics and the associated computational methods. This pivotal contribution showcased David's brilliance and set him apart as a visionary in his field. This was also evident in his contribution to the early development of the *GAMS* software, a pathbreaking software package that widened the scope and made work easier for generations of applied economists.

Throughout his illustrious career, David's dedication to advancing knowledge and fostering collaboration knew no bounds. As a co-founder of this journal *Computational Economics* in 1988, and later president of the *Society of Computational*

¹ David's contributions to the journal were celebrated in a Special issue of the *Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control* **26**, 2002. <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/abs/pii/S0165188901000744?via%3Dihub>.

² Kendrick, D.A. *Stochastic Control for Economic Models* McGraw Hill Book Company, New York, 1981.

Economics, he played a central role in shaping the discourse of our discipline. The publication of the first *Handbook on Computational Economics*³ in 1996 and undergraduate textbook *Computational Economics*,⁴ in 2006, stand as a testament to his enduring legacy and his commitment to the field of computational economics.

To honor his contributions to the field, the Society of Computational Economics created the *David A. Kendrick Distinguished Service Award* to be given on an irregular basis to individuals who stand out for their contributions to the fields of computational economics and finance. The inaugural award was presented to David during a banquet at the Royal Society in London in July 2010.

Beyond his research achievements, David was known for his warmth, generosity, and outgoing kindness. As a teacher, he inspired generations of students to pursue their passions with fervor and dedication, leaving an indelible mark on their lives.

1.2 The Friend

To those who had the privilege of calling David a friend, his presence brought light and joy. For more than four decades, he graced our lives with his wisdom, humor, and continuing support.

David was a family man in the true sense of the word. Devoted to his wife Gail, proud of his children Ann and Colin, and as *Grandy*, he was the grandfather you hope for. Alongside his beloved wife, children, and grandchildren, David became an integral part of our families, enriching our lives with his boundless love and compassion. As an example, it spoke volumes about David's character that he took care of his chronically ill wife Gail unequivocally for many years while maintaining his cheerful demeanor. A demeanor that was supported by, our frequent visits to *Amy's icecream shops*, a local specialty in Texas. Many good ideas were conceived at Amy's.

It was very sad that David lost his daughter Ann about a year ago. A harsh life moment that feels so unfair. It was for us very encouraging to see that he spent the last years of his life in the good and loving care of his son Colin.

As we mourn the loss of our dear friend, let us remember David Kendrick not only for his scholarly achievements but also for his enduring kindness and generosity of spirit. To his son, grandchildren, and all who held him dear, we extend our deepest sympathies and heartfelt wishes during this difficult time.

Though David may not be with us, his legacy of love, knowledge, and compassion will continue to inspire us for generations to come. He will be profoundly missed, but his spirit will live on.

³ *Handbook of Computational Economics* 1, North-Holland, Amsterdam, 1996.

⁴ *Computational Economics* Princeton University Press, 2006.

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